

Qingyang Liu

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Education

Duke University, School of Medicine, Durham, NC

Aug. 2024 – May 2026

Master of Biostatistics

University of Washington, Seattle, WA

Sept. 2020 – June 2024

BS in Applied Computational Mathematical Science

Experience

Machine Learning Research Assistant, Duke University Rohit Singh Lab

Oct. 2024 - Present

- Built a scalable graph-based ranking pipeline across 33 biological networks, improved recall value by 30%
- Reduced pipeline runtime by 50% through algorithmic optimization and streamlined data workflow
- Developed automated single-cell integration pipelines with representative sampling and feature engineering
- Launched a Streamlit ML app enabling user input, real-time inference, and decision-support outputs

Data Science Research Assistant, Duke Center for AIDS Research

Oct. 2024 - Present

- Ran large-scale clustering and unsupervised ML on genomic datasets to identify population patterns
- Evaluated model performance using TCA, V-measure, and related metrics to improve clustering reliability
- Optimized parameters and detection thresholds to increase sensitivity and specificity of marker identification
- Delivered insights through region- and subtype-level comparative analyses to support surveillance decisions

Algorithm Engineering Intern, Ping'an Technology

July 2023 – Sept. 2023

- Applied interpolation and curve fitting to improve synchronization between speech and lip movements in AI figures
- Automated analysis of 80,000+ videos in Python, extracting metadata and streamlining workflows for efficiency
- Built and managed databases by uploading and classifying 11,000+ minutes of video data for AI training pipelines
- Processed and optimized raw video data with FFmpeg, adjusting parameters to maximize clarity and visual quality

Projects

Pilot Trial Designing Software, Duke University

Aug. 2024 - Present

- Built simulation and Bayesian models to assess pilot-trial feasibility, dropout risk, and data-driven design decisions
- Developed a Shiny app for automated scenario testing and analysis, improving planning efficiency and guidance

LLM Safety & Interpretability with Sparse Autoencoders, Duke University

Nov. 2025 – Dec. 2025

- Identified toxicity- and hallucination-aligned SAE features and built classifiers with strong detection performance
- Applied feature-level steering to hidden states to reduce unsafe generations and improve answer accuracy

Reinforcement Learning Algorithm Benchmarking, Duke University

Nov. 2025 – Dec. 2025

- Benchmarked DQN, A2C, and PPO with ablations to assess key algorithm components across control tasks
- Analyzed stability and efficiency, highlighting actor-critic advantages in continuous-control environments

Vaccine Reservation System, University of Washington

Dec. 2021

- Designed a relational SQL database with Java integration, including queries, procedures, and supply-chain simulation
- Built user-facing modules for secure login, appointment scheduling, and availability monitoring for vaccine reservation

Skills

Programming Language: Python, R, SQL, Java

Machine Learning: PyTorch, Scikit-learn, LightGBM, TensorFlow, XGBoost, Cross-Validation

Data Analysis: A/B Testing, Statistical Modeling, Pandas, NumPy, Matplotlib, Seaborn, Shiny, Data Visualization

Tools & Platforms: Git, Docker, FFmpeg, LaTeX, Linux